GoPiGo3 Getting Started with Bullseye

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GoPiGo3 with Raspberry Pi OS Bullseye MicroSD Card

Purpose: Download and install Raspberry Pi OS Bullseye on a GoPiGo3.

Raspberry Pi OS is Linux: All commands in **Raspbian** are **case sensitive**

NOTE: Remove all USB drives from computer except the MicroSD adapter.

1. Insert a MicroSD adapter with a minimum 8 GB MicroSD card into a USB port on your computer.
2. Download and install **Raspberry Pi Imager:** https://www.raspberrypi.com/software
3. Start Raspberry Pi Imager → Choose Device: **Raspberry Pi 3 or 4**
4. Choose OS → **Raspberry Pi OS (Legacy, 32-bit) A port of Debian Bullseye with Security updates and desktop environment**.
5. Click **CHOOSE STORAGE → TS-RDF5 SD Transcend** (or whatever device has the MicroSD card)
6. Click the Gear icon in the lower right side.
    a. Set hostname
    b. Set username and password: pi Password01
    c. Configure wireless LAN
    d. Set locale settings.
    e. Go to Services: Enable SSH → Use password authentication
7. Write file to MicroSD card **Write:** Write the image
8. When prompted: Remove the MicroSD adapter.

Boot and Connect to the GoPiGo3

1. Power off the GoPiGo3.
2. Plug in the external Wi-Fi adapter.
3. Insert the MicroSD card in the Raspberry Pi.
4. Power up the GoPiGo3. This will take a little longer the first time you boot the robot.

The GoPiGo3 should connect to your wireless network.

There are a couple of ways to find the GoPiGo3's IP address. Note the IP address, you will need it to connect with SSH.

Network Scanner Method

- Advanced IP Scanner - https://www.advanced-ip-scanner.com
- Use ZenMap with Quick Scan setting www.nmap.org

Your GoPiGo3 should show up on your network scan with an IP address.

Plug in an Ethernet Cable

You may have to plug in an Ethernet cable to the GoPiGo3. Rescan.

Last Resort: Keyboard, Mouse, Monitor

Connect a keyboard, mouse and monitor to the GoPiGo3. Connect to or point to the wireless or wired connection. You want the IP address.

You finally have the IP address.

1. Go to https://www.chiark.greenend.org.uk/~sgtatham/putty/latest.html
2. Download the **PuTTY** client.
3. Start the **PuTTY** client. Type in the **IP address** of the GiPiGo3 → Click **Open**.
4. **Accept** the **PuTTY Security Alert**.
5. Login as the username and password that you set.
6. Type: **sudo raspi-config**
    a. **Interface Options → VNC** → Select **Yes.**
    b. **Interface Options -> SPI →** Select **Yes.**
    c. **Interface Options -> I2C →** Select **Yes.**
    d. **Advanced Options** → **A1 Expand Filesystem**
7. Exit the **raspi-config** interface. Reboot when prompted.

Update Raspberry Pi OS

Reconnect with PuTTY at a terminal. Run the following command to update the Pi OS.

```
# Update the apt package list
sudo apt update
```

```
# Upgrade all packages -y no prompt
sudo apt dist-upgrade -y
# Remove any packages that are not needed, there may not be any
sudo apt autoremove
# It is a good idea to reboot after an update
sudo reboot
```

Disable Onboard Wi-Fi

The internal Pi antenna works just fine. For better signal strength and range you may want to use an external USB Wi-Fi antenna.

To use an external Wi-Fi antenna only, disable the internal Wi-Fi.

1. Reconnect using PuTTY.

```
# Edit this file with nano
sudo nano /boot/config.txt
# Add this line to the end of the file and save it
dtoverlay=disable-wifi
```

2. Restart the Pi.

```
sudo reboot
```

NOTE: After you have disabled the on-board Wi-Fi, you must always plug a Wi-Fi adapter into a USB port.

Multiple SSID's

Edit the following file if you wish to setup more than one wifi SSID. If there is more than SSID in range, priority=5 sets 'YourSSID' over priority=4 for 'YourOtherSSID' If they are not in range of each other, make them both 1.

Use the following command to edit the wpa_supplicant.conf file.

```
sudo nano /etc/wpa_supplicant/wpa_supplicant.conf
```

The following shows an example of how you might configure another SSID.

```
ctrl_interface=DIR=/var/run/wpa_supplicant GROUP=netdev
update_config=1
country=US

network={
   ssid="YourSSID"
   psk="YourPSK"
   priority=1
}
network={
   ssid="YourOtherSSID"
   psk="YourOtherPSK"
   priority=1
}
```

1. **CTRL+O** (Writes the file)
2. **Enter** to finish saving the file.
3. **CTRL+X** (Exit nano)

The pi will automatically connect to whichever wireless network is closer and has better signal. You can add as many wireless networks to this file as you wish.

Setup GoPiG3 Software

Use PuTTY to connect to the GoPiGo3. At the terminal, type the following commands without sudo. The libraries will install properly only if installed as the pi user.

You can copy and paste the commands into PuTTY. Use Shift Insert to paste into PuTTY.

1. Run the following commands to download the setup and test scripts.

```
wget https://raw.githubusercontent.com/itinstructor/GoPiGo3/main/setup_gopigo3_on_32-bit_Bullseye.sh
wget https://raw.githubusercontent.com/slowrunner/GoPiGo3-Bullseye_32-bit/main/test_read_info.sh
```

2. Run the setup script.

```
bash setup_gopigo3_on_32-bit_Bullseye.sh
```

3. Installing the GoPiG3 software will take some time.
4. Shutdown the Raspberry Pi with shutdown with poweroff to make the settings take effect.

```
sudo shutdown -h now
```

5. Power up the GoPIGo3. Run the following test script.

```
bash test_read_info.sh
```

Configure VNC Display Settings

Connect with PuTTY.

Uncomment and modify the following:

```
# Edit the config.txt file
sudo nano /boot/config.txt

hdmi_force_hotplug=1
hdmi_group=2
hdmi_mode=51
```

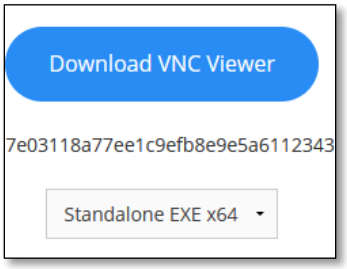
Add **video=HDMI-A-1:1280x720@60D** followed by a single space to the beginning of cmdline.txt (keep everything all on 1 line).

```
# Edit the cmdlilne.txt file
sudo nano /boot/cmdline.txt

# Paste this at the beginning of the file. Make sure there is a single space
after this and everything is on one line.
video=HDMI-A-1:1280x720@60D
```

RealVNC Viewer

RealVNC viewer allows us to remotely control the Pi in headless mode over the network. Headless mode is when there isn't a keyboard, video, or mouse.



1. Go to https://www.realvnc.com/en/connect/download/viewer/
2. Download the VNC Viewer Standalone EXE anywhere you want to run the program from. You don't have to install it.
3. Double Click **VNC Viewer**.
4. Type in the IP address of your Pi → Click **Connect**.

If RealVNC doesn't work, try TigerVNC.

TigerVNC Viewer

You can remote control the GoPiGo3 in headless mode.

1. https://sourceforge.net/projects/tigervnc/
2. Download the latest vncviewer64 exe.
3. This is a self executing program, it does not need an installation.
4. Double Click the downloaded file.
5. Type in the IP address of your robot → Click **Connect**.
6. If the desktop is not displayed, you may need to connect with PuTTY. Use **sudo reboot** to restart the Pi.

Configure Raspberry Pi OS (Optional)

1. **Change Clock Display:** Right Click Clock, Digital Clock Settings
    a. To show seconds, **%r**
    b. To show minutes: **%I:%M %p**
2. **Add Temperature Monitor:** Right Click Task Bar → Panel Settings → Panel Applets tab.
    a. **Add** → **Temperature Monitor** → **Add**.
    b. Click **Up** to move the Temperature Monitor to the left on the taskbar.
    c. Click **Preferences**.
        i. **Normal color**: **#00008b** (Dark blue)
        ii. **Warning1 temperature**: 60
        iii. **Warning2 temperature**: 80

Setting up a Gmail Account for Email

If you don't have a Gmail account, you will want to create one.

Let's enable your Gmail account to receive connections from external programs, like Python.

1. Open your browser and access your Gmail account.
2. On the login screen → enter your Gmail username and password.

3. After the login → access the following URL: https://myaccount.google.com/signinoptions/two-step-verification

4. Enable the two-step verification on this account.

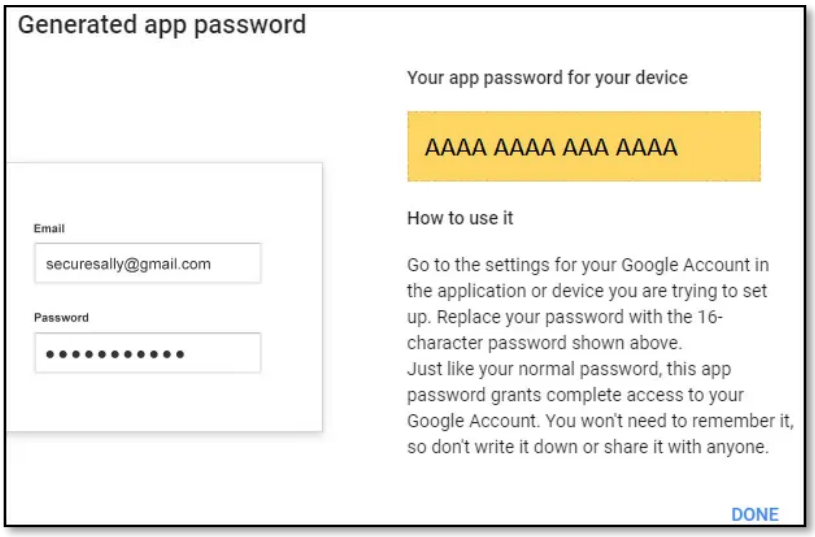
Create an Application Password

1. Access the following URL: https://security.google.com/settings/security/apppasswords

2. Select Gmail application and the type of device: **Other**.

3. Name the device: **Python**

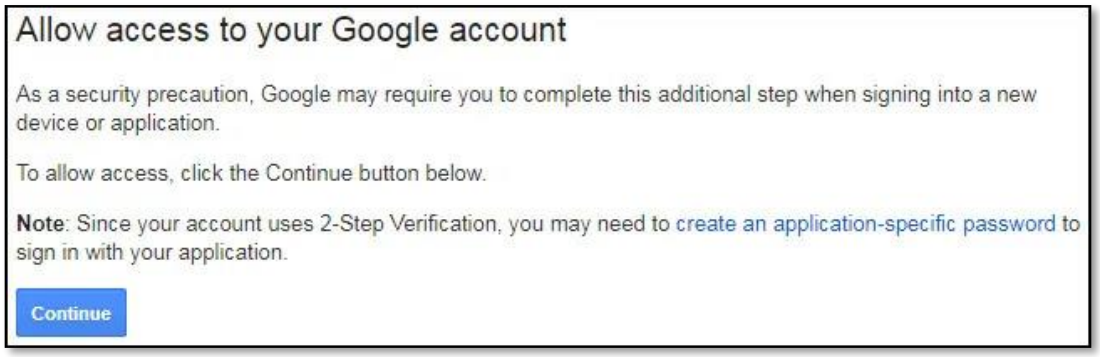
4. Click on the Generate button and take note of the randomly generated password.



5. Access the following URL:

6. https://accounts.google.com/DisplayUnlockCaptcha

7. Click on the **Continue** button to enable external access to your Google account.



You have finished the required steps for the Gmail integration.

Email IP Address on Startup

We want our GoPiGo3 to email us it's IP address on startup.

Complete the following steps on the GoPiGo3 desktop.

1. Create a folder to store your Python programs.

```
mkdir /home/pi/Code/
cd /home/pi/Code/
# Use the following command to download startup_mailer.py
wget https://raw.githubusercontent.com/itinstructor/GoPiGo3/main/Raspberry%20Pi/startup_mailer.py
```

2. Edit startup_mailer.py → **nano startup_mailer.py**

3. Change the **EMAIL_DESTINATION** email address to your own email address.

4. Change **EMAIL_SOURCE** and **EMAIL_APP PASSWORD** to your Gmail account that you setup to send email through.

5. Save the file.

6. Open a terminal.

7. Type in the following to make the script executable.

```
sudo chmod 755 /home/pi/Code/startup_mailer.py
```

8. There should not be any errors if the command was successful.

9. Test the script with the following command.

```
python3 /home/pi/Code/startup_mailer.py
```

10. In a few moments, you should receive an email with your GoPiGo3 IP address.

Run startup_mailer.py Script on Startup

1. At the terminal, type in the following command to access the Raspbian scheduler. (Don't add sudo)

```
crontab -e
```

2. Press **Enter** to edit the file with nano.
3. Cursor to the bottom of the file. (The mouse will not work.)
4. Enter or copy and paste the following information. (sleep 15 waits 15 seconds after startup to run the script.)

```
@reboot sleep 15 && python3 /home/pi/Code/startup_mailer.py
```

5. Type **CTRL+S** to Save the file.
6. Press **CTRL+X** to Exit nano.
7. Reboot the pi: **sudo reboot**
8. You should receive an email with your IP address.

16 Tick Motors

Some GoPiGo3 motors operate on 16 ticks rather than 6 ticks. You can tell because the wheels go very slowly.

1. Edit the gpg3_config.json as shown.

```
nano /home/pi/Dexter/gpg3_config.json
```

2. Change ticks to 16 as shown below

```
{"wheel-diameter": 66.5, "wheel-base-width": 117, "ticks": 16, "motor_gear_ratio": 120}
```

3. Reboot the Raspberry Pi to make the settings take effect: **sudo reboot**

Visual Studio Code

Visual Studio Code is available on the Raspberry Pi. It will be automatically updated when the system is upgraded.

```
sudo apt update
sudo apt dist-upgrade -y
sudo apt install code
```

Set Desktop Shortcuts to Open Without Prompt

In **File Manager** → **Edit** → **Preferences** → Check **Don't ask options on launch executable file**

Wi-Fi Signal Strength

The **iwconfig** command will give you a snapshot of Wi-Fi quality.

wavemon will monitor Wi-Fi signal strength in real time.

```
# Install wavemon
sudo apt install wavemon -y
# Run wavemon
wavemon
# Quit wavemon
q
```

Signal Strength

The higher the signal strength, the more reliable the connection and higher speeds are possible. The signal strength is specified as -dBm (decibels related to one milliwatt).

Values between 0 and -100 are possible, with more being better. -51 dBm is a better signal strength than -60 dBm.

The value 0 is not realistic. Even -30 dBm is hard to reach, and you have to stand almost directly next to the access point.

Some guidance on how to read the results:

- 50 dBm is considered an excellent signal strength.
- 67 dBm is said to be the minimum signal strength for reliable and relatively fast packet delivery.
- 70 dBm is the minimum signal strength for reliable packet delivery.
- The minimum value for a basic connection is -80 dBm. However, packet delivery is no longer necessarily reliable.

- 90 dBm is already very close to the basic noise. Here a connection probably does not work anymore.

Link Quality

A network can have very good signal strength without good link quality.

This is how much of the data you send and receive will make it to the destination in good condition.

The quality indicator includes data like Bit Error Rate (BER), i.e., the number of bit errors in received bits that have been altered due to noise, interference, distortion, or bit synchronization errors. Others are Signal-to-Noise and Distortion Ratio (SINAD).

It is measured in percentage or on a scale of up to 70. So you will see a value like "60/70".

Unlike signal strength, it is somewhat harder to say which values are still considered to be ok.

If the value is low and your signal strength is high, you may have interference from, e.g., kitchen appliances or other electronic devices. Moving them further away may improve the link quality.

Frequency

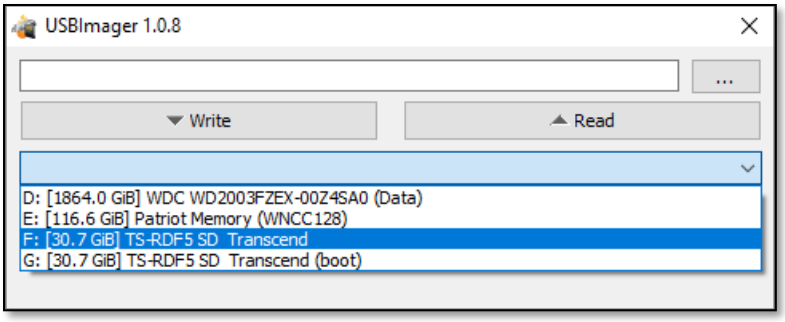
Another interesting indicator is the Wi-Fi frequency.

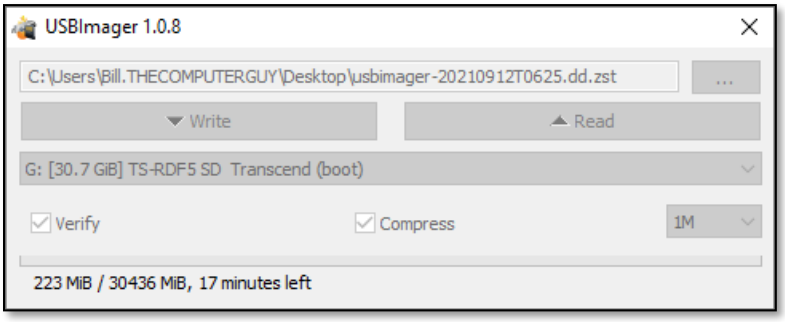
This shows if your Raspberry Pi connects to the slower and longer range 2.4 GHz network, or the faster but shorter range 5 GHz version, provided, of course, that your router offers both networks.

Backup GoPiGo3 to a File Image

Things go wrong. It is a good idea to back up your MicroSD card to a file image at this point and any point prior to making big changes.

1. Go to https://gitlab.com/bztsrc/usbimager
2. Download the windows GDI version.
3. This is a portable program, there is not an installation, the program runs from wherever you put it.
4. Click the downward pointing triangle as shown to select your MicroSD card. The card will show 2 partitions, it doesn't matter which one you choose, the entire card will be backup up to a file image.



5. Click **Compress**.

6. Click **Read**. The program will automatically create a compressed backup file of approximately 5GB on your Desktop.